lenavh.dev

Dear Halden Pay Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role. Halden Pay's focus on building a shared data platform with reusable frameworks strongly matches the work I have done owning ingestion, orchestration and production data pipelines, and the kind of engineering I value: well-tested systems, clear data contracts and reliable data for the teams who use it.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own ingestion and orchestration across approximately 140 Airflow DAGs and have helped evolve the warehouse and streaming platform. I migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into 420+ dbt models, reducing the nightly build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 50 minutes. I also introduced JSON Schema data contracts with CI checks, built a Kafka pipeline processing approximately 30 million shipment events per day, and replaced hourly full-table extracts with Debezium CDC. These projects have strengthened my experience operating production platforms, improving data quality and making platform capabilities more reusable.

My payments experience at Kovalent Pay is also directly relevant to Halden Pay. I built PySpark reconciliation jobs on AWS EMR, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files daily, and helped reduce manual month-end reconciliation from approximately 3 days to approximately 4 hours. I also designed a dimensional Redshift warehouse for finance and risk. Alongside delivery, I mentor data engineers, run platform office hours, contribute to open-source Airflow code and teach SQL at a local women-in-tech meetup.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience with Airflow, dbt, Python, SQL, cloud data warehouses and platform operations could contribute to Halden Pay's Data Platform team and its work with analytics, data science and product colleagues. Thank you for your consideration.

Kind regards, Lena Varga-Holm